

All Jazz Scales (by chord type)



Julian Bradley
JazzTutorial.com

Your challenge: First play every scale in this document over the chord it goes with. Next, decide which scales you actually like best (one scale per chord).

Next, practice playing your chosen scales from all 12 notes, with the chords in your left hand.

Difficulty level = Medium

Theory: You can play any scale that 'agrees' with the chord's chord tones (1 3 5 7). All scales below contain the chord tones to their chord - but vary in the missing notes (2 4 6).

While there are many scales you could play over any chord (beyond the ones listed here), there are certain 'go to' scales that Jazz musicians use. Here they are:

Major 7 scales:

MY RECOMMENDED SCALE:

Cmaj7 C major scale

Cmaj7 C lydian scale

Cmaj7 C major blues scale

Cmaj7 C major bebop scale
(major scale + #5)

Pentatonic scales:

Cmaj7 C pentatonic

Cmaj7 G pentatonic

Cmaj7 D pentatonic

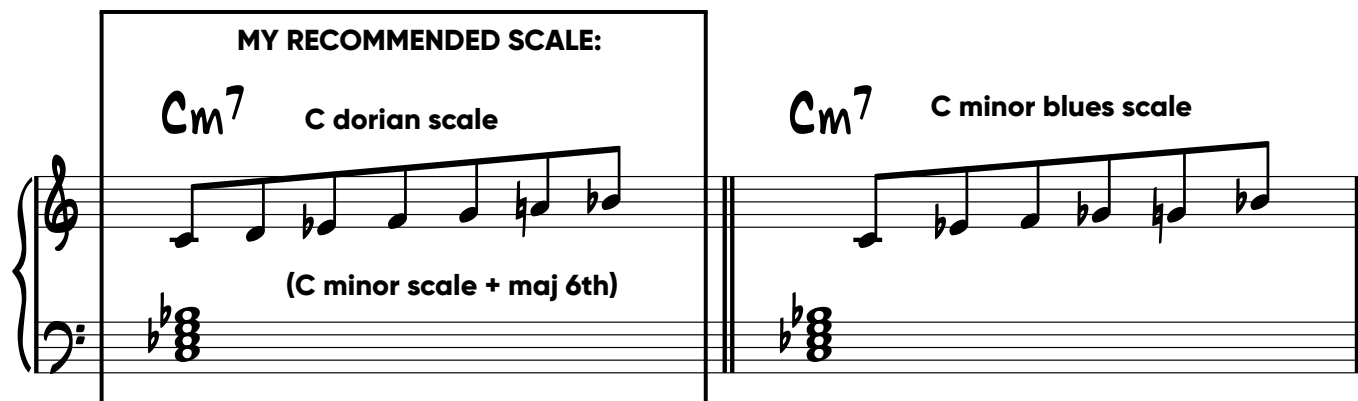
(really these are all C lydian scale - simplified into 5 note sections)

Minor 7 scales:

MY RECOMMENDED SCALE:

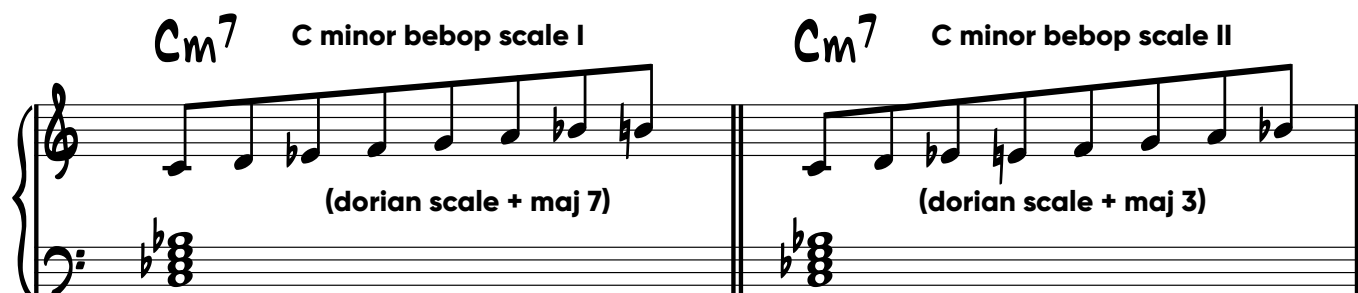
Cm⁷ C dorian scale
(C minor scale + maj 6th)

Cm⁷ C minor blues scale



Cm⁷ C minor bebop scale I
(dorian scale + maj 7)

Cm⁷ C minor bebop scale II
(dorian scale + maj 3)

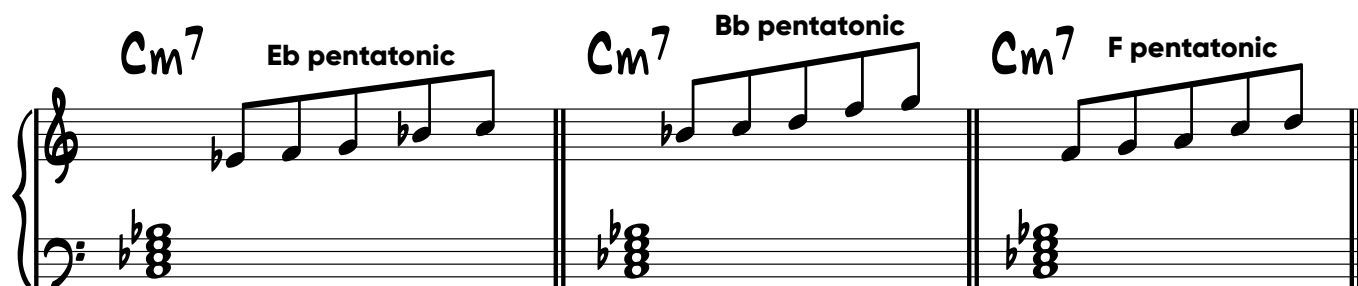


Pentatonic scales:

Cm⁷ Eb pentatonic

Cm⁷ Bb pentatonic

Cm⁷ F pentatonic

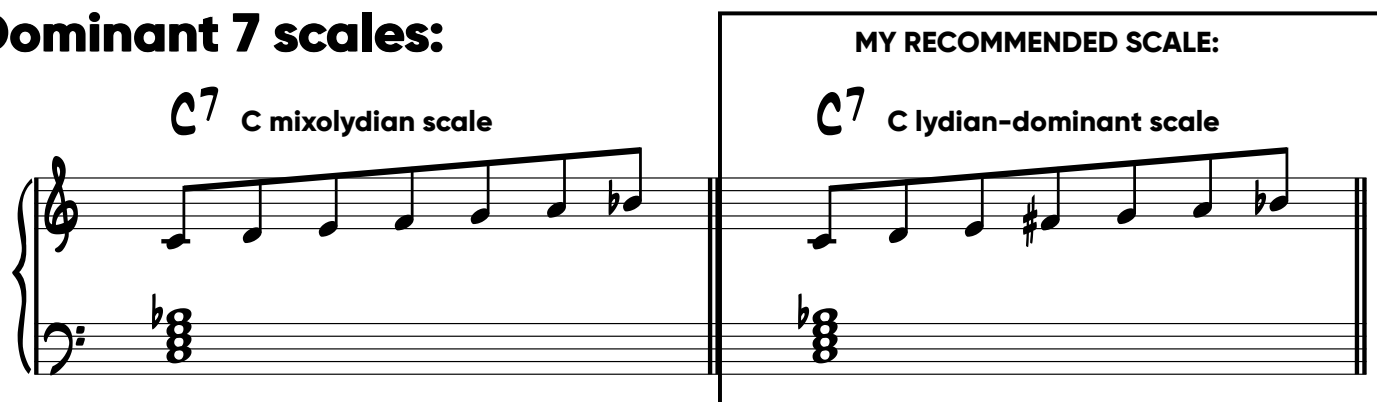


(really these are all C dorian scale - simplified into 5 note sections)

Dominant 7 scales:

C⁷ C mixolydian scale

MY RECOMMENDED SCALE:
C⁷ C lydian-dominant scale



Dominant 7 scales (continued):

C⁷ C major blues **C⁷(#9) C minor blues** **C⁷ C dominant bebop**

(slight clash but often works)

Pentatonic scales:

C⁷ C pentatonic **C⁷ Bb pentatonic** **C⁷ALT. Gb pentatonic**

Advanced dominant 7 scales: (use on minor ii-V-I's)

MY RECOMMENDED SCALE:

C⁷ALT. C altered scale think of it like this: **Db melodic minor**

C⁷(#11) C diminished scale 1 (half > whole)

Note: There are two diminished scales:
1. Half-step > whole-step (goes over V7 chords).
2. Whole-step > half-step (goes over dim 7 chords)

Half-diminished scales (min 7 b5)

Cm7(b5) C locrian scale think of it like this: Db major scale

The image shows two musical staves. The left staff is for the C locrian scale, starting on C4 and ascending with notes C, Bb, Ab, Gb, F, Eb, and D. The right staff is for the Db major scale, starting on Db4 and ascending with notes Db, Eb, F, G, Ab, Bb, and C. Both scales are shown in a piano accompaniment with a bass line of two octaves below the root.

Cm7(b5) C half-diminished scale think of it like this: Eb melodic minor scale

The image shows two musical staves. The left staff is for the C half-diminished scale, starting on C4 and ascending with notes C, Bb, Ab, Gb, F, Eb, and D. The right staff is for the Eb melodic minor scale, starting on Eb4 and ascending with notes Eb, F, G, Ab, Bb, C, and D. Both scales are shown in a piano accompaniment with a bass line of two octaves below the root.

Other chords:

C°7 C diminished scale 2 (whole > half) **C7(#5)** C whole-tone scale

The image shows two musical staves. The left staff is for the C diminished scale 2 (whole > half), starting on C4 and ascending with notes C, Bb, Ab, Gb, F, Eb, and D. The right staff is for the C whole-tone scale, starting on C4 and ascending with notes C, D, Eb, F, G, and Ab. Both scales are shown in a piano accompaniment with a bass line of two octaves below the root.

Tip: If you ever don't know which scale to play - just play the chord tones (1 3 5 7). These four notes create their own four-note scale.

"Why do I need to know this?"

Chords and scales are always related:

- the chord plays notes from the scale in 'chord form' (multiple notes at once).
 - the melody plays notes from that same scale in 'melody form' (one at a time).
- But both chord and melody pull their notes from the same scale.

For every Jazz chord you learn, you want to know which scale goes with it. Every chord goes with a scale (or multiple scales). The two go together.

You also need to know which scale goes with each chord if you want to compose your own Jazz songs. Or if you want to improvise over a chord progression using scales (although it's simpler to improvise using chord tones + approach patterns, rather than scales).